

Debates

A debate is a formal discussion where people speak for or against a topic. Each side gives reasons to support their views and tries to convince the audience or judges.

Meaning (Simple)

A debate is an argument with rules, where two teams discuss one topic.

Common Debate Terms

Motion: The topic to be discussed

Example: Technology is more harmful than helpful.

Proposition/Affirmative: Supports the motion

Opposition/Negative: Opposes the motion

Moderator/Chairperson: Controls the debate

Audience: People listening to the debate

Types of Debate

Formal Debate – Used in schools and competitions

Informal Debate – Casual discussion

Parliamentary Debate – Used in government

Panel Debate – Group discussion on a topic

Structure of a School Debate

Introduction of the topic

Speakers from the Proposition speak

Speakers from the Opposition speak

Rebuttal (responding to opponents' points)

Conclusion

Importance of Debate

Improves speaking skills

Builds confidence

Develops critical thinking

Teaches listening and respect for opinions

Example of a Debate Topic

This house believes that examination malpractice should attract severe punishment.